

Agnieszka Besz

VP of Engineering · games, real-time products and engineering leadership

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ABOUT

I am an engineering leader with 15+ years in games and real-time products. I started as a programmer and moved into technical and organizational leadership as the products and teams grew. Today I lead engineering at Decentraland. I also build products through GB Factory, which keeps me close to architecture and implementation.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- 15+ years across games, consumer platforms and real-time systems.
- Led technology departments of up to 50 people; current VP scope includes client engineering, Creator Tools and SDK.
- Built and grew distributed teams across startups, live games and global studios.
- Shipped products with Ubisoft, Rovio, Next Games/Netflix Games and Decentraland.
- Experienced in release quality, engineering effectiveness and building teams that do not depend on one person to keep moving.

SELECTED IMPACT

- At Decentraland, led up to 25 developers across client engineering, Creator Tools and SDK in 10 countries, covering client technology, creator workflows, QA and release delivery.
- Owned 14 Explorer repositories and production distribution across desktop, web and Epic Games Store.
- Shipped ~50 production releases per year with zero hotfixes across a recent 52-day release window.
- Lowered hardware requirements to open the product to more users by reducing CPU usage, memory usage and GPU memory pressure.
- Simplified the technical stack by removing obsolete technology and led performance work toward stable 60 FPS with 100 concurrent users.

WORK EXPERIENCE

VP of Engineering - Decentraland Foundation, London

2025 – Present

- Lead the engineering organization and QA; also led Creator Tools and SDK for a period, with peak scope of 25 developers across 10 countries.
- Own technical strategy for 14 Explorer repositories, the Unity/C# desktop client, Launcher/distribution path and desktop, web and Epic Games Store channels.
- Led technical direction for the desktop Launcher rework in Rust: install/update pipeline, code-signed Windows builds and Epic Games Store distribution.
- Directed performance and accessibility work that lowered hardware requirements by reducing CPU usage, memory usage and GPU memory pressure.
- Introduced AI-assisted engineering workflows for code review, QA support and knowledge sharing, including audits that surfaced 45+ dead abstractions.
- Improved delivery discipline and people systems: predictable weekly releases with zero hotfixes across a recent 52-day window.

Founder & Technical Director - GB Factory

2022 – Present

- Run a small product studio and technical consultancy, building software and helping teams with architecture, performance and release engineering.
- Current work includes Animal Park, a multiplayer mobile game for iOS and Android, plus AI engineering assistants, finance automation and release engineering systems.

Engineering Manager - Decentraland Foundation, London

2022 – 2025

- Grew the client team from ~5 to 10+ engineers and led execution of the new Explorer client that replaced the legacy web client.
- Owned client KPIs including loading time, stability, responsiveness and frame rate, and built the tech-debt program behind them.
- Changed release execution from ad hoc shipping to predictable weekly cadence, monitoring, QA gates, crash reporting, hang detection and performance checks.

Head of Frontend Development - Ten Square Games

2021 – 2022

- Led a 50-person technology department supporting seven live game teams during a period of rapid growth.
- Modernized lifecycle tooling and drove shared-library adoption so product teams could iterate faster with less duplicated engineering effort.

Technical Manager - Rovio (now Sega), Helsinki

2019 – 2021

- Led Angry Birds Journey from concept to soft launch and managed, mentored and grew the programming team behind it.

Senior Software Engineer - Next Games (now Netflix), Helsinki

2017 – 2019

- Built core systems, new mechanics and live-ops features for Stranger Things: Puzzle Tales and The Walking Dead: No Man's Land.

Associate Lead Programmer → Programmer - Ubisoft RedLynx, Helsinki

2015 – 2017

- Built core systems, real-time synchronous PvP, AI and UI for South Park: Phone Destroyer; led performance optimization and a small programmer group.

SELECTED PROJECTS

AI Assistant

TypeScript / Node.js / Claude Agent SDK / MCP / Telegram / email

- Self-hosted assistant with CLI, private Telegram and email ingress, isolated work/personal profiles, tool permissions, audit logs, calendar integration and safe local file access.

AI Finance Automation

Python / model-agnostic document pipelines / dashboards / finance estimates

- Model-agnostic AI pipelines for finance workflows: documents are read and classified by an LLM, while deterministic code owns every number, dashboard, estimate and reporting package.

Engineering Management Dashboard

GitHub Actions / scheduled agents / Sentry MCP / Unity Cloud costs / dashboard

- Dashboard and scheduled agents for engineering management: releases, CI health, Sentry signals, Unity Cloud cost data, priority reviews, team load and AI-assisted summaries.

<https://gbfactory.uk> <https://aixacode.github.io>

EXECUTIVE EXPERTISE

- Engineering strategy & technical vision
- Technical product leadership
- Organizational design & hiring
- AI adoption in engineering teams
- Technical simplification
- Release quality & quality systems
- Technical due diligence & advisory work

AI

- LLM applications & agent systems
- Claude Agent SDK / MCP
- RAG & document pipelines
- AI-assisted development workflows
- Tool permissions & audit trails

ENGINEERING

- CI/CD & release engineering
- Observability & DevOps
- QA automation & quality gates
- Real-time multiplayer systems
- Performance & reliability
- Product and technical architecture

PLATFORMS

- Unity
- Firebase / GCP
- Docker, Linux, Proxmox
- GitHub Actions, fastlane
- Sentry, Grafana

PROGRAMMING

- C#
- TypeScript / Node.js
- Python
- Rust

DOMAINS

- Real-time systems
- Consumer products
- AI-powered products
- Developer productivity
- Technical consulting

EDUCATION

Doctoral studies, Computer Science - Turku & Opole Univ. of Technology (2013 - 2015, not completed)

MSc, Computer Science - Opole University of Technology (2012 - 2013)

BSc, Computer Science - Opole University of Technology (2008 - 2012); exchange year at Vaasa UAS, Finland

RECOGNITION

DirectX 11 Competition

Best Pitch - Startup Journey Demo Day

3 publications: mobile AR, inspection tooling, shooting-sports apps

SPOKEN LANGUAGES

- Polish (native)
- English (professional)
- Finnish (elementary)